

Finance close collaboration guide

Cedar Works | March close completed 2026-04-06 | Shared operating reference

Purpose and shared outcome

This guide coordinates the recurring month-end close across Finance and operational owners. The completed March close is the reference point: Q1 revenue was JPY 1,842m, EBITDA was JPY 222m, and the cash variance was JPY 12.4m unfavorable. The goal is a fast, reconciled close with clear accountability and timely escalation.

Close rhythm and accountable hand-offs

Milestone	When	Accountable	Output / decision
Subledgers and cut-off locked	Apr 1	Controller	Evidence-complete cut-off
Cash and accrual inputs complete	Apr 2	Treasury Analyst Department Owner	Cash position and accrual log
Preliminary flash	Apr 3	Controller	Initial P&L and cash view
Variance bridge review	Apr 4	FP&A Lead	Bridge reconciles to JPY 12.4m
Package review	Apr 5	Reviewer	Evidence gaps resolved
Close published	Apr 6	Controller	Shared Q1 close pack
Town hall / actions	Apr 13	FP&A Lead	Owners confirm next actions

Role operating model

Controller is accountable for the close, sign-off, and escalations. **Accounting Lead** owns ledger readiness and accrual integrity. **FP&A; Lead** owns the operating story and variance bridge. **AP Lead** owns settlement timing. **Treasury Analyst** owns cash positioning. **Department Owner** supplies complete accrual context. **Reviewer** challenges evidence and control completion. Use the RACI workbook as the task-level source of responsibility.

Cash variance bridge and escalation

The JPY 12.4m unfavorable cash variance is explained in four visible drivers. Each driver must tie to the preliminary flash, the bridge review, and the shared close pack.

Driver	JPY m unfavorable	Primary owner	Escalation
Collections timing	7.2	Treasury Analyst	Notify Controller by 12:00
Vendor settlement timing	3.1	AP Lead	Notify Accounting Lead by 12:00
Payroll and benefits timing	1.3	Accounting Lead	Notify Controller by 12:00
Other working capital	0.8	Department Owner	Notify Controller by 12:00
Total	12.4	Controller	Reconciled bridge

Escalation rules

Trigger	Action	Decision owner
Cash variance exceeds JPY 10.0m unfavorable	Treasury Analyst shares the driver view by 12:00 and confirms collection / settlement timing.	Controller
Accrual or cut-off evidence is missing	Department Owner or Accounting Lead resolves the gap before the review package.	Accounting Lead
Bridge does not reconcile	FP&A; Lead isolates the driver difference and refreshes the bridge before review.	Controller
Review exception remains open	Reviewer records the exception, due date, and accountable owner in the close pack.	Controller

Control standard: close is complete only when the bridge ties to JPY 12.4m, task ownership is visible, review evidence is resolved or explicitly logged, and the Controller publishes the shared close pack.